

Dependent Prepositions & Questions Ending in a Preposition

EIC · Escola de Idiomas e Cultura · Level B2

01 Reading · The Vendor Who Remembered My Name

7 min read

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Traveling alone, I quickly learned to **rely on** the kindness of strangers — the elderly woman at the market who slipped an extra plum into my bag, the taxi driver who **waited for** me outside the station without complaint. Nobody at home **believed in** my ability to manage two months alone in a country whose language I barely spoke. I was **afraid of** getting lost, **worried about** running out of money, and secretly **proud of** myself for buying the plane ticket at all.

By the third week, the market felt nothing like home — **different from** the quiet supermarkets I was used to, loud and specific and warm. There was a fish vendor, a man everyone seemed to **depend on** for the freshest catch, who somehow remembered my name after a single conversation. I **apologized for** my terrible pronunciation every time I ordered, and every time he laughed and corrected me anyway.

"He never asked what I was looking for. He simply gave me something to look forward to."

I hadn't expected to **succeed in** making a single local friend, let alone several. I was **surprised at** how quickly the city stopped feeling foreign. The vendor's daughter, who was studying to become a teacher, was **interested in** practicing her English, and we began meeting for tea every Sunday — both of us **satisfied with** a friendship built on nothing more than a shared market stall and imperfect grammar on both sides.

Looking back, I'm grateful to that vendor more than almost anyone else on the trip. He never asked what I was looking for. He simply gave me something to **look forward to**, every single week, in a language I was only just beginning to understand.

GLOSSARY

vendor · 売り子 · vendedor(a)**catch** (noun) · 漁獲 · pesca do dia**slip** (verb) · そっと入れる · colocar discretamente**plum** · 梅 · ameixa**market stall** · 屋台 · 露店 · barraca de mercado**let alone** · まして～ない · muito menos, quanto mais

Spot the Preposition

- Find one **verb + preposition** combination used for feelings of trust. _____
- Find one **adjective + preposition** combination describing an emotion. _____
- What does Yuki say she was surprised at? _____

02 Grammar Focus · Verb + Preposition

PREPOSITION	VERBS	EXAMPLE
ON	depend, rely	"You can always depend on / rely on your family in a crisis."
IN	believe, succeed	"She believes in hard work, and it helped her succeed in the exam."
FOR	apologize, apply, wait	"I apologized for being late, then waited for the bus, then applied for the job online."
ABOUT	worry, care	"Don't worry about the weather — we both care about having fun more than staying dry."
WITH	agree, deal	"I agree with your plan, but you'll have to deal with your brother's complaints."

TRADUÇÃO · VERB + PREPOSITION

depend on · 頼る · 依存する · depender de

believe in · 信じる · acreditar em

apologize for · 謝る · pedir desculpas por

wait for · 待つ · esperar por

care about · 気にかける · importar-se com

deal with · 対処する · lidar com

rely on · 頼る · 当てにする · contar com

succeed in · 成功する · ter sucesso em

apply for · 応募する · candidatar-se a

worry about · 心配する · preocupar-se com

agree with · 同意する · concordar com

look forward to · 楽しみにする · estar ansioso por

REAL TALK

These combinations don't follow a logical rule — the preposition is simply **part of the verb's identity**. *Depend on* is a single unit of meaning. The only real strategy is repetition. Also note: *look forward to* is always followed by a noun or -ing form, never a bare infinitive (not "look forward to see you" — "look forward to seeing you").

つまり: これらの組み合わせには論理的なルールはなく、前置詞は動詞のアイデンティティの一部です。唯一の戦略は繰り返しです。"look forward to" の後は常に名詞か -ing 形です。

Complete each sentence with the correct preposition.

1. I'm really looking forward _____ seeing the autumn leaves this year.
2. The whole village depends _____ tourism during the summer months.
3. She apologized _____ the delay and offered us a free drink.
4. I don't fully agree _____ the new check-in policy.
5. He applied _____ a job at the ryokan and started the following month.
6. Please don't worry _____ the extra luggage — we have plenty of space.
7. After years of practice, she finally succeeded _____ opening her own tea shop.
8. I'll deal _____ the reservation — you can relax and enjoy the view.

03 Grammar Focus · Adjective + Preposition

PREPOSITION	ADJECTIVES	EXAMPLE
IN	interested	"She's interested in Japanese pottery."
OF	afraid, proud, aware	"He's not afraid of spiders, and he's proud of it."
ABOUT	worried	"I'm worried about missing the last train."
FOR	famous, responsible	"This town is famous for its hot springs."
TO	similar	"This ryokan is similar to the one we stayed at."
FROM	different	"City life is very different from village life."
WITH	satisfied	"We were satisfied with the service."

TRADUÇÃO · ADJECTIVE + PREPOSITION

interested in · 興味がある · interessado em

proud of · 誇りに思う · orgulhoso de

worried about · 心配している · preocupado com

responsible for · ～に責任がある · responsável por

different from · ～と違う · diferente de

surprised at · 驚いている · surpreso com

afraid of · 怖がる · com medo de

aware of · 気づいている · ciente de

famous for · ～で有名 · famoso por

similar to · ～に似ている · parecido com

satisfied with · 満足している · satisfeito com

good at · ～が得意 · bom em

REAL TALK

Watch two famous traps. First: *married* takes **to**, never "with." Second: *different* traditionally takes **from** in careful writing — safe and correct everywhere.

つまり: 2つの罠に注意 — "married" は必ず "to"。"different" は正式には "from" で、どこでも常に正解です。

Complete each sentence with the correct preposition.

1. I've always been interested _____ the history of tea ceremonies.
2. This dish is very different _____ anything I've tried before.
3. He's genuinely afraid _____ flying, even after all these years.
4. This region is famous _____ its cherry blossoms in spring.
5. We were very satisfied _____ the room, even though it was small.
6. I'm a little worried _____ the typhoon reaching the coast this weekend.
7. She's always been good _____ reading maps, even without her phone.
8. As the eldest son, he was responsible _____ the family shop after his father retired.

04 Grammar Focus · Questions Ending in a Preposition

You already know this move from passive voice — the preposition gets left behind ("stranded") at the end of the question.

- 1 **Find the preposition partner.** Locate the verb or adjective and its fixed preposition.

"She is interested in modern art." → interested IN

- 2 **Turn the object into a question word.** A thing becomes *what*; a person becomes *who*.

"modern art" → What

- 3 **Add the question form, and strand the preposition at the end.**

"What is she interested in?"

REAL TALK

Verb example: "He depends on his sister." Step 1: depends ON. Step 2: "his sister" → who. Step 3: bring in *does* and strand the preposition: "Who does he depend on?" The verb drops to its base form once *does* appears.

つまり: 動詞の例 — ステップ3で does を加え、前置詞を最後に残します: "Who does he depend on?". does が出たら動詞は原形に戻ります。

Transform each statement into a question ending in a preposition.

1. She is worried about the exam results. → _____
2. He relies on his eldest daughter. → _____
3. The plan is similar to last year's itinerary. → _____
4. They are proud of their grandson. → _____
5. She applied for a teaching position. → _____
6. He's responsible for the whole kitchen. → _____
7. The company is dealing with a difficult supplier. → _____
8. You're most afraid of something specific. → _____

05 Mixed Practice · Prepositions & Questions

12 items

Items 1–8 need the missing preposition. Items 9–12 ask you to turn a statement into a question ending in a preposition.

1. This tea is famous _____ its bitterness — locals say it's an acquired taste.
2. I'm aware _____ the rules, but the sign was still hard to find.

3. She succeeded _____ convincing the whole family to travel together this year.
4. He's not satisfied _____ the new schedule — too many early mornings.
5. We're really looking forward _____ the festival next weekend.
6. The whole staff depends _____ the head chef's schedule.
7. I was surprised _____ how empty the shrine was on a Sunday.
8. He apologized _____ forgetting the reservation.
9. She's afraid of heights. → _____
10. He agrees with his business partner. → _____
11. The festival is similar to a harvest celebration. → _____
12. They're grateful to the rescue team. → _____

06 Scenario Corner · Ask & Answer

For each prompt, first write the question ending in a preposition, then answer it about your own life.

01

Ask about something a person is **interested in**.

02

Ask who someone **relies on** the most.

03

Ask what someone is **afraid of**.

04

Ask what someone is **proud of**.

05

Ask what a place or thing is **famous for**.

06

Ask who someone is **grateful to**, and why.

07

Ask what someone is **worried about** right now.

08 · YOUR OWN QUESTIONS

Write two of your own questions using different dependent prepositions from today's lesson — then ask a friend or your teacher.

07 Closing · Takeaways

- ▶ **Verb + preposition:** depend on, rely on, believe in, succeed in, apologize for, apply for, wait for, worry about, care about, agree with, deal with, look forward to.
- ▶ **Adjective + preposition:** interested in, afraid of, proud of, aware of, worried about, famous for, responsible for, similar to, different from, satisfied with, surprised at, good at.
- ▶ **Questions ending in a preposition:** find the preposition partner → turn the object into what/who → strand the preposition at the end.
- ▶ There's no shortcut for memorizing which preposition goes with which word — only repetition.

Answer Key

01 • SPOT THE PREPOSITION

1. rely on / depend on / believe in · 2. afraid of / worried about / proud of / surprised at · 3. How quickly the city stopped feeling foreign.

02 • VERB + PREPOSITION

1. **to** · 2. **on** · 3. **for** · 4. **with** · 5. **for** · 6. **about** · 7. **in** · 8. **with**

03 • ADJECTIVE + PREPOSITION

1. **in** · 2. **from** · 3. **of** · 4. **for** · 5. **with** · 6. **about** · 7. **at** · 8. **for**

04 • QUESTIONS ENDING IN A PREPOSITION

1. What is she worried about? · 2. Who does he rely on? · 3. What is the plan similar to? · 4. Who are they proud of? · 5. What did she apply for? · 6. What is he responsible for? · 7. Who is the company dealing with? · 8. What are you most afraid of?

05 • MIXED PRACTICE

1. **for** · 2. **of** · 3. **in** · 4. **with** · 5. **to** · 6. **on** · 7. **at** · 8. **for** · 9. What is she afraid of? · 10. Who does he agree with? · 11. What is the festival similar to? · 12. Who are they grateful to?

06 • SCENARIO CORNER

Open production — teacher-assessed. Check that the question is correctly formed with the preposition stranded at the end, and that the answer responds naturally.